

1. Introducing Government and Politics

What is Politics?

1. "Man is by nature a political animal."
2. Politics is the authoritative allocation of resources.
3. Politics is that who gets what, when and how.
4. Politics is the sign of who gets what, when, and why.
5. Politics is the study of how people get what they want.
6. The meaning of the term Politics has been confined to business and activity which has to with the actual conduct of the affairs of the state.
7. The process by which we select our governmental leaders and what policies these leaders produce. Politics produces authoritative decisions about public issues.

What is Government?

1. A government is the system to govern a state or community.
2. The institution or institutions that possess the basic authority and can legitimately use force to rule over a society.
3. The body of persons that constitutes the governing authority of a political unit or organization
4. Government the system or form by which a community or other political unit is governed.
5. Government, the political system by which a country or community is administered and regulated.
6. A government is the system or group of people governing an organized community, generally a state.
7. Government is the institution through which a society makes and enforces its public policies.
8. A government is a system of social control under which right to make laws, and the right to enforce them, is vested in a particular group in society.
9. The institutions and processes through which public policies are made for society.
10. A set of individuals with both the power and authority to control and direct the affairs of a group, society or country.
11. Government is an organization or administration in which a group of people work together as a unit (elected by people of the country) to run the nation as indicated by the defined law.
12. Government is a group of people who rule or run the institution of a country. In other words, it may be said that a government is the body of representatives that governs and controls the state at a given time. Government is the medium through which the power of the state is employed.

Scope of Political Science (SAN PPP)

A) Study of state and government

Political Science studies the nature, origin, and functions of the state and government.

Example: Bangladesh's government system, including the role of the Prime Minister and Parliament in decision-making.

B) Study of associations and institutions

It examines (পরীক্ষা নেয়) political organizations and institutions, their origin, nature, and development.

Example: Political parties, courts, Election Commission of Bangladesh, which organizes and monitors fair elections.

C) Study of national and international problems

It deals with national unity, territorial security, and international political issues.

Example: Bangladesh's efforts to handle the Rohingya refugee crisis in cooperation with Myanmar and international organizations like the UN.

D) Study of political behavior of man

It studies how people think, act, and behave in political situations.

Example: The voting behavior of Bangladeshi citizens during the 2018 general election.

E) Study of the past, present and future of development

It focuses on the historical, current, and future progress of the state and its institutions.

Example: Bangladesh's development from its independence in 1971 to becoming a rapidly growing economy today.

F) Study of the concepts of power, authority & influence

It analyzes power, authority, political culture, and influence in society and politics.

Example: Ziaur Rahman had a strong influence in Bangladesh by creating the BNP and shaping national policies.

Political Ideology

What is Political Ideology?

One's basic beliefs about power, political values and the role of government.

Grows out of economical, educational, and social conditions and experiences.

An *ideology* is a set of opinions or beliefs of a group or an individual. Very often *ideology* refers to a set of political beliefs or a set of ideas that characterize a particular culture.

A definition of ideology must be neutral: it must reject the notion that ideologies are good or bad true or false, or liberating or oppressive.

~~✗~~ # Ideology as an action-oriented belief system, an interrelated set of ideas that in some way guides or inspires political action.

List of political ideologies

Political Ideology¹	Core Frames²	Ideological Markers³
<i>Anarchism</i>	anti-clericalism, anti-statism, economic freedom, utopianism	chaos and disorder, direct action, free, autonomous human beings, natural social order, no economic control, no management, no political authority, no regulation, perfect society, radicalism, respect, social solidarity, stateless society, unnecessary state, unregulated market economy, voluntary agreement
<i>Conservatism</i>	authority, hierarchy, human imperfection, organic society, tradition, property	common morality, faith in God, family traditions, family values, functionalism, guidance for social actions, hierarchical society, individual tendency for corruption, national identity, national loyalty, paternalism, pragmatism, search for security, social gradation, social justice, social obligations, social order, social principles, state authority, strong criminal regime, strong government, traditional mores, traditional practices
<i>Ecologism</i>	conservation, ecology, environmental ethics, holism, sustainability	air pollution, biodiversity, climate change, ecological balance, ecosystems, environmental organisations, environmental protection, global warming, natural disasters caused by human interventions, natural resources, non-human life, preservation, renewable sources, restoration and/or improvement of the natural environment, social balance and harmony, soil and water pollution, sustainable growth, waste management
<i>Fascism</i>	anti-rationalism, elitism, leadership, state socialism, struggle, ultra-nationalism	anti-capitalist, anti-communist, anti-conservative, anti-immigration, anti-intellectualism, anti-liberal, authority, commitment and faith, competition natural for human progress, corporatism, duty, heroism, honour, patriarchy, power, progress, self-sacrifice, state worship
<i>Feminism</i>	equality and difference,	abortion, anti sex oppression, anti-subordination, body autonomy and integrity, child sexual abuse, deconstructing gender identities,

Authority

In the fields of sociology and political science, authority is the legitimate power of a person or group over other people. In a civil state, authority is practiced in ways such a judicial branch or an executive branch of government.

Authority refers to the legal and formal right to give commands and make decisions. For example, a manager has the authority to revise employees' work schedules based on the needs of the company.

1. The power or right to give orders, make decisions, and enforce obedience.
2. A person or organization having political or administrative power and control.
3. The power to determine, adjudicate, or otherwise settle issues or disputes; jurisdiction; the right to control, command, or determine.
4. A power or right delegated or given; authorization: Who has the authority to grant permission?
5. A person or body of persons in whom authority is vested, as a governmental agency: The housing authority provides rental assistance payments to low-income residents. The bridges and piers are built and maintained by the Port Authority.
6. Usually authorities. persons having the legal power to make and enforce the law.

Weber's Three Types of Authority

Type	Example
TRADITIONAL	Patrimonial, Patriarchy
CHARISMATIC	Mother Teresa, Napoleon
RETIONAL- LEGAL	Bangladesh Jatio Sanshod

Comparison Table

Sr No	Particular	Charismatic	Traditional	Legal Rational
1	Type of ruler	Charismatic leader	Dominant personality	Functional superiors or bureaucratic officials
2	Position determined by	Having dynamic personality	Established traditional or routine	Legal established authority
3	Ruled Using	Extra-ordinary qualities and exceptional powers	Acquired or inherited (hereditary qualities)	Virtue of rationally established norms, decrees, and other rules and regulations
4	Legitimized	Victories and success to community	Established traditional or routine	General belief in the formal correctness of these rule and those who enact them are considered a legitimized authority

Comparison Table

Sr No	Particular	Charismatic	Traditional	Legal Rational
5	Loyalty	Interpersonal & personal allegiance and devotion	Based on traditional allegiance (commitment)	To authority/ rules
6	Cohesion (Structure / organization)	Emotionally unstable and volatile	Feeling of common purpose	Abiding by rules
7	Leadership	Rulers and followers (disciples)	Established forms of social conduct	Rules, not rulers

Difference between power and authority

Authority is legally enforced and is derived from level of position in an organization.

Authority is formal based upon superior and subordinate relationship.

Since authority is related with position in an organization, it has limited scope and is confined to organizational structure

Authority is just and applied equally

Authority is institutional and is given by organization to a position. Anybody who is offered that positions, enjoys the authority attached to that position.

Authority relationship can be found out by anybody by looking up the organization chart. There are authority centers

Authority is always attached to the position. The higher the position on the organization chart, the bigger the authority.

Authority has no concern with the politics because it is not attached to a person. Power is attached to a person.

Power however is individual and independent and originates from charisma and social positioning.

Power is informal and is based upon individual understanding.

Power is linked with an individual and transcends boundaries.

Power may be used indiscriminately.

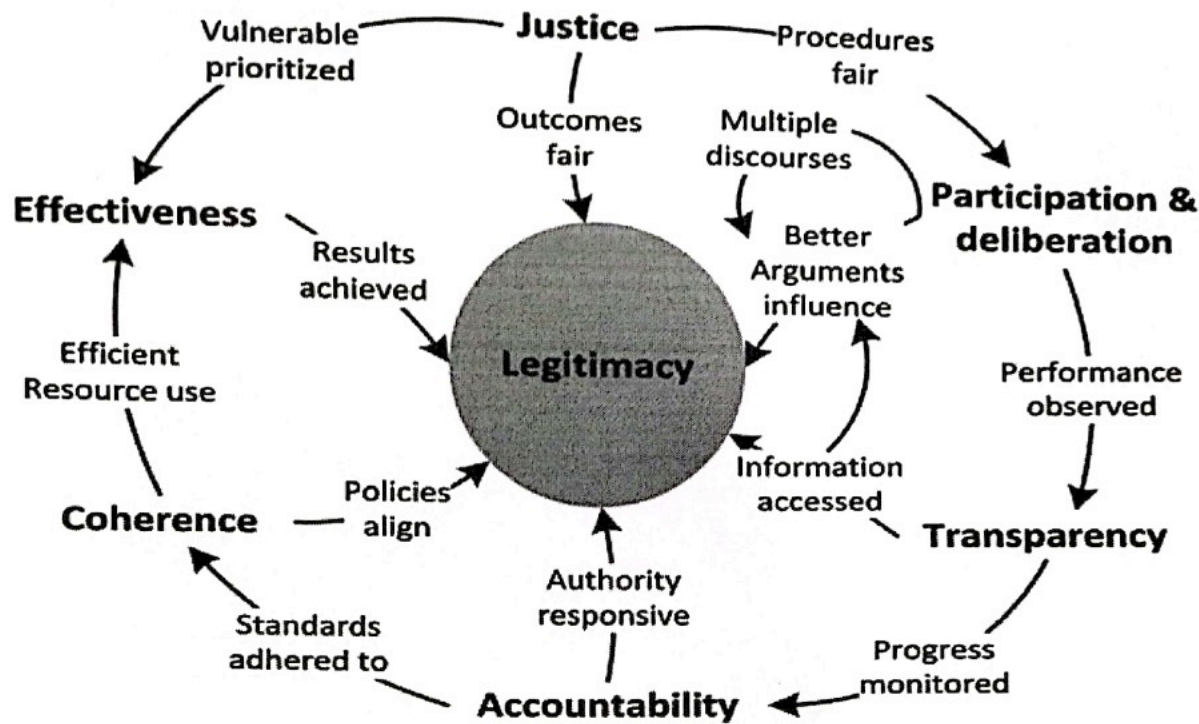
Power is not so given by the institution. It is one's ability to influence others decision and it is acquired by the people.

But there is no power centers dotted on the organization chart and it cannot be located anywhere else.

Power has no relation with the position. A person even at low level may enjoy the power of influencing the decision making or even highly placed official having a lot of authority, may be proved powerless

Element of politics is inherent in power

Sources of Legitimacy



Sources of Political Legitimacy

All governments need legitimacy to survive. But how do governments attain authority? What makes citizens obey or feel loyal toward their governments? Scholars have answered these questions by concluding that political legitimacy comes from several sources:

- **Tradition:** The government has authority because its citizens have a long tradition of giving it authority and respect. This source mostly comes into play with governments that have been around for a long time.
- **Habit:** Most people are raised to obey the laws, and they thereby acquire the habit of obeying. Citizens give their government legitimacy and authority because that is what they have always done.
- **History:** People remember great deeds and events in the country's history, and they obey the government out of a sense of historical pride.
- **Religion:** In some places, obedience to the government is seen as a religious obligation.
- **Ethnic identity:** Countries composed of exclusively one ethnic group or whose regime is strongly connected to one ethnic group can inspire obedience through ethnic identity. Members of that ethnic group respect the government because of its link to their ethnicity.
- **Results:** If a government succeeds in some way—for instance, through a military victory or a thriving economy—citizens may feel loyalty because of that success.
- **Elections:** A government that holds elections gains legitimacy because citizens believe that the government, composed of elected officials, represents them.
- **International recognition:** A government gains legitimacy when other governments recognize it and welcome it to the international community.

What are the 7 characteristics of a nation?

You will notice that the difference between a state and a nation is basically about their different distinguishing features.

- Common Descent
- Geographical Boundaries
- Government
- Common Language
- Infrequent Internal Ethnic Conflicts
- Common Religion
- Same Cultural Practices

1. Common Descent

Persons inhabiting a nation usually have a common origin and descent.

2. Geographical Boundaries

A nation which is at the same time a state has clear-cut geographical boundaries. People that form a nation may live within a defined territory.

3. Government

Most nation-states have their own political institutions that come together to form a government.

4. Common Language

Inhabitants of a nation have a common language

5. Infrequent Internal Ethnic Conflicts

One other unique characteristic (and advantage) of a nation is the fact that conflicts and disagreements are not as pronounced as is the case in diverse and heterogeneous states.

6. Common Religion

People inhabiting the nation tend to have a common religion.

7. Same Cultural Practices

People of a nation usually have common customary or traditional practices. This is perhaps one of the most striking characteristics of a nation.

What are the 8 elements/the roots of nationalism?

- **Political**—desire for power or autonomy.
- **Social**—concern for group values, customs and traditions.
- **Economic**—concern for standard of living or monetary gain.
- **Culture**—shared beliefs and a way of life create a common bond.
- **History**— a shared past connects people as a group.
- **Religion**—a common religion helps unites people.
- **Language**— a common language is a key element of nationalism.
- **Territory**—a shared land gives people a sense of unity.

Essential Elements of State

The State Must, Therefore, Possess the Essential Elements of State are-

1. Population,

2. Territory

3. Government

4. Sovereignty

1. Population is Essential Elements of State.

Two conclusions flow from the discussion on the meaning and nature of the state:

(1) that the State is a human institution the product of man's gregarious nature and the result of necessities of human life, and

(2) population and land are the starting point of any study of man in his organized groups. It is the people who make the State; without them, there can be none. But the population must be large enough to make a State and sustain it.

2. Territory

The small States, on the other hand, are relatively less secure. They fall easy prey to bigger States, which are usually aggressive, and history is full of examples of many a naked aggression. Hitler in no time trampled Poland and other Central European countries. Japan did the same in the Far East.

The recent opinion is invariably in favor of the bigger States. Trietschke, the German philosopher, in his work on "Politics" (Politik), published a little before World War-I, declared that "the State is power," and it is a sin for the State to be small. He said that even the idea of a small State is ridiculous because of its weakness, which in itself is reprehensible because it masquerades as strength.

3. Government.

The purpose of living together cannot be realized unless they are properly organized and accept certain rules of conduct. The agency created to enforce such rules of conduct and to ensure obedience is called government. Government is the focus of the common purpose of the people occupying a definite territory. Through this medium, common policies are determined, common affairs are regulated, and common interests are promoted.

Without government, the people will be just a babel of tongues with no cohesion and means of collective action. They would divide themselves into groups, parties, and even warring associations, creating conditions of utter chaos and even civil war.

Therefore, there must be a common authority and a consequent order wherever people live. It is the prerequisite of human life, and, as such, the government is an essential element of the State. The State can not exist without a government, no matter what form a government may assume.

4. Sovereignty

The sovereignty of the State is its most essential and distinguishable feature. As people inhabiting a definite portion of territory and having a government do not constitute a state. They must be internally supreme and free from external control. The sovereignty of the State has two aspects, internal sovereignty, and external sovereignty. Internal sovereignty is the State's monopoly of authority inside its boundaries.

This authority cannot be shared with any other State, and none of its members within its territory can owe obedience to any other State. If the State admits no rival within its own territory, it logically follows that it has no authority outside its own territory.

ORIGIN OF STATE

☐ **DIVINE ORIGIN THEORY**

☐ **THEORY OF FORCE**

❑ SOCIAL CONTRACT THEORY

❑ EVOLUTIONARY THEORY

DIVINE ORIGIN THEORY

The supporters of this theory believed that the state doesn't come into being by the people but it is the handiwork of God on the earth, the theory of divine origin of the state is **the oldest theory** of the origin of the state.

the theory explains about how the state came into existence. According to Plato the state cannot be established **without faith in God**. The king of Egypt was held as God. According to Christianity God appoints the king.

The Divine Origin Theory of the state believes in the following postulates:

- (1) King is appointed by the God.
- (2) The right of kingship is hereditary.
- (3) The king is responsible to God for his actions.
- (4) It is sin to disobey the command of the king.

Advantages of the Divine Origin Theory The divine origin theory of the state had the following advantages:

1. The fear of God **maintained discipline and peace** in the subjects and resulted in spontaneous subordination.
2. This **conjoined religious and political institutions**. Thus, religion and the state ruled together.
3. This theory-maintained obedience, cooperation and the sense of responsibility among the citizens.
4. It **provided for a moral basis** to the state as the morality was derived from religion.

Causes of the Rejection of Divine Origin

However, the following causes led to rejection of the Divine origin theory of state in the seventeenth century:

1. The **social contract theory** of the origin of the state requested to the people.
2. The **church and the state** were separated in Europe.
3. The rise of **Nationalism** also gave blow to this theory as it was opposed to the autocracy of the king.

THEORY OF FORCE

According to Leacock, the theory of force as origin of the state, means that the **state is the result of war**. In the words of Voltaire, "The first king was a fortunate (successful) warrior." War created the king. Thus, according to this theory, the state does not depend on religion or on logic or reason, but on force.

θ The most ancient of all laws, **gives to the stronger rule** over the weaker."

θ According to this theory "**State is power**, it is sin for a state to be weak, state is the public power of offence and defense."

θ Oppenheimer said that the aim of the state is the **economic exploitation** of the weak subjects.

θ Engels has written, "**Without force** and iron nothing is achieved in history."

Value of Force Theory

The following may be pointed out in its favor:

1. It is true that states have been **built by force**. No states have been born without force.
2. From practical viewpoint also, **force is required by a state**. In the words of Kant, "Even a population of devils would find it to their advantage to establish a coercive state by general consent.
3. Wars also support the value of force. The force, however, cannot be considered as the sole and only cause of the origin of the state. These elements such as will of them asses etc., should also be considered.

SOCIAL CONTRACT THEORY

Some thinkers in ancient Greece, supported social contract theory of state. It has been admitted by Plato and Aristotle. But the most important support and explanation of the social contract theory of state, was found in the works of Thomas Hobbes, John Locke and Jean Jacques Rousseau.

Fundamentals of Social Contract Theory

In spite of differences in details in the theories advanced by Hobbes, Locke and Rousseau the following characteristics may be held as the fundamental principles of the social contract theory:

- ☐ According to this theory the state is based upon a contract between the ruler and the ruled and among the ruled themselves.
- ☐ This theory is against the evolutionary theory of the state. According to this theory men have created the state and men maintain it for the fulfillment of their needs.
- ☐ Though Hobbes, Locke and Rousseau equally admit the theory of Social Contract, they have expressed different ideas concerning the nature of this contract. For some writers, the contract was social for others it was legal while for some it was both.
- ☐ All these thinkers admit that authority is a necessary element of state.
- ☐ These thinkers have interpreted human nature differently. Hobbes considered it as selfish while Locke considered it as altruistic. Rousseau accepted both.

EVOLUTIONARY THEORY

According to the followers of evolutionary theory, the state has not been born but is a result of evolution. In the words of Burgess, "The state is a product of history, means that it is gradual and continuous development of human society. "Thus, the state has gradually evolved.

Necessity of State

The necessity of the state can be understood through various philosophical, political, and social lenses. Here are some key points highlighting its importance:

1. Order and Security

- **Law Enforcement:** The state maintains law and order through police and judicial systems, protecting citizens from crime and ensuring justice.
- **National Defense:** A state provides defense against external threats, maintaining sovereignty and protecting its citizens.

2. Public Services

- **Infrastructure:** The state is responsible for building and maintaining infrastructure such as roads, schools, and hospitals.
- **Social Services:** It provides essential services, including healthcare, education, and welfare programs, to promote the well-being of its citizens.

3. Economic Stability

- **Regulation:** The state regulates the economy to prevent monopolies, protect consumers, and ensure fair practices.
- **Fiscal Policy:** It manages taxation and public spending to promote economic stability and growth.

4. Social Cohesion

- **National Identity:** The state fosters a sense of belonging and national identity among its citizens, which can promote social cohesion.
- **Conflict Resolution:** It provides mechanisms for resolving disputes among individuals and groups, reducing social tensions.

5. Representation and Democracy

- **Political Participation:** The state enables citizens to participate in governance through democratic processes, ensuring that their voices are heard.
- **Rights Protection:** It upholds and protects the rights and freedoms of individuals, promoting equality and justice.

6. Crisis Management

- **Disaster Response:** The state coordinates responses to natural disasters, public health crises, and emergencies to protect citizens and restore order.
- **Economic Interventions:** It can intervene in the economy during recessions or crises to stabilize markets and support recovery.

	Government	Governance
Polity		
N B Number of institutions	Few	Many
Bureaucratic structure	Hierarchical, Consolidated	Decentred, Fragmented
Politics		
N P Networks	Closed/Minimal	Extensive
Power relations	<u>Public authorities</u> as steering <u>subjects</u> , <u>private actors</u> as steering <u>objects</u>	Unclear division between steering subjects and steering objects
Policy		
M S <u>Mode of policies</u>	Routinized	Innovative learning
<u>Steering mode</u>	Regulations and Norms, Commands or prohibition	Agreements and compromises

Source: Own tabulation on the basis of Albers 1993, Benz 2005 and John 2001

- SOCIAL CONTRACT THEORY
- EVOLUTIONARY THEORY

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